KAREN ATKINSON | PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Where Does Your School Need Space to Grow?

A two-page reflection for Waldorf educators and school leaders. Use it to move beyond a vague sense that “something needs attention” and identify the developmental work that could create the greatest shift.

Begin here.
Strong professional development is not simply more training. It creates a pathway: reflection, mentoring or coaching, meaningful observation, shared agreements, accountability, and renewed pedagogical inspiration.

1. Take the pulse

Which areas are asking for attention right now? Check all that feel alive.

- ■ Faculty relationships & trust
- ■ Curriculum clarity & goals
- ■ Observation & feedback
- ■ Assessment / reporting
- ■ Shared agreements
- ■ Leadership alignment
- ■ Mentoring / coaching
- ■ Accountability
- ■ Pedagogical inspiration
- ■ Professional growth plans
- ■ Governance / collaboration
- ■ Time & space to grow

2. Name the pattern beneath the issue

What keeps repeating, even after conversations, meetings, or previous professional development?

Where is the gap between what your school *values* and what is consistently *lived in practice*?

3. Clarify the desired shift

FROM What is happening now?	**TO** What would healthy movement look like?

One sentence: If our school made meaningful progress in the next 3-6 months, we would notice...

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What Kind of Support Would Move This Forward?

The goal is not to choose a service first. It is to identify the kind of support the situation actually requires - individual development, sustained leadership partnership, or facilitated work with the wider community.

4. Find the right level of support

■ **A. An individual educator needs a developmental partner**	A teacher is ready for sustained reflection, practical guidance, and support translating insight into classroom practice. **Best-fit pathway: Mentoring & Coaching**
■ **B. Leadership needs a steady strategic anchor**	A leader or leadership team is navigating growth, faculty development, governance, transitions, or the movement from vision into sustainable practice. **Best-fit pathway: School Leadership & Development Partnership**
■ **C. The whole community needs shared space**	Faculty, administration, or board members need facilitated dialogue, renewal, alignment, shared meaning-making, or concrete next steps. **Best-fit pathway: One-Day Mastermind Renewal, Retreat & Facilitation**

5. Make the work concrete

What would you want Karen to see, hear, or understand before offering guidance?

Who needs to be part of the work for change to hold?

What is one outcome you would want to be able to point to six months from now?

You do not need to have the solution before you ask for support.

Bring the pattern, the context, and the change you hope to see. Karen's work is designed around the actual people, culture, and developmental needs of each school - not a standardized program.

Next step: Apply to work with Karen and use this completed reflection as the starting point for the conversation.